prisoners who are waiting to be hanged', but that '[p]erhaps I am the only man amongst them who is anxiously waiting for the day when I will be fortunate enough to embrace the gallows for my ideals'. He then asserts, 'I will climb the gallows gladly and show to the world as to how bravely the revolutionaries can sacrifice themselves for the cause.' He goes onto tell B.K. Dutt, 'I am condemned to death, but you are sentenced to transportation for life' so that '[t]hose revolutionaries who have by chance escaped the gallows, should live and show to the world that they cannot only embrace the gallows for the ideal but also bear the worst type of tortures in the dark dingy prison cells'.[8]

The only wish Bhagat Singh had was a say in the manner of his going. He did not wish to go as a common criminal. Everything he had said and done from the beginning to the end demonstrated that he was a freedom fighter. He was a prisoner of war. This is because his act in the assassination of J.P. Saunders was an act of political murder in what was a war waged by the Indian nation against the King of England. And, this is exactly how he had been charged and tried. His crime did not arise from a personal vendetta. Nor was it a crime for personal gain. So, like a prisoner of state, he demanded to be shot by the state. He did not want to be hanged like a criminal. So he, together with Sukhdev and Rajguru, wrote to the Punjab governor, as the day of execution drew closer. They explained that 'we were sentenced to death on 7th October 1930 by a British Court, L.C.C. Tribunal, constituted under the Special L.C.C. Ordinance, promulgated by H.E. The Viceroy' and that this being so, 'the main charge against us was that of having waged war against H.M. King George, the King of England'. Indeed, the 'findings of the court presupposed two things', namely, that 'there exists a state of war between the British nation and the Indian nation' and that 'we had actually participated in that war and were, therefore, war prisoners'. Against this background,

> Let us declare that the state of war does exist and shall exist so long as the Indian toiling masses and their natural resources are being exploited by a handful of parasites. They may be purely British capitalists or mixed British and Indian, or even purely Indian. They